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YEN 157.46

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The U.S. labor market** defied expectations in September, adding 119,000 jobs, but the unemployment rate rose slightly to 4.4%, the highest level in four years. **A1**

◆ **Home sales hit** an eight-month high in October. **A2**

◆ **Blockbuster Nvidia results** sparked a furious rally from Tokyo to New York before indexes reversed course and tumbled. The Nasdaq, S&P 500 and Dow fell 2.2%, 1.6% and 0.8%, respectively. **A1, B10**

◆ **A planned \$20 billion** bailout to Argentina from three large U.S. banks has been shelved as bankers pivot instead to a smaller, short-term loan package, people familiar with the matter said. **B1**

◆ **Walmart reported** strong sales for the most recent quarter and raised its financial outlook for the year. **B1**

◆ **Paramount, Comcast** and Netflix have submitted bids for Warner Bros. Discovery, owner of the storied Warner Bros. studio and HBO. **B1**

◆ **Cracker Barrel** shareholders voted to retain the company's embattled CEO after a calamitous rebranding. **B2**

◆ **Abbott Laboratories** has agreed to acquire cancer diagnostics company Exact Sciences in a \$21 billion deal. **B1**

◆ **Bath & Body Works** shares fell 25% after the retailer reported a drop in sales and earnings and slashed its forecast. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **The Justice Department** is investigating whether some Trump administration officials improperly shared information about its mortgage fraud investigation into Sen. Adam Schiff (D, Calif.). **A3**

◆ **Trump called** for the arrest of Democratic lawmakers who appeared in a video calling for members of the U.S. military to disobey illegal orders. **A3**

◆ **The U.S. peace plan** for Ukraine demands sweeping territorial and security concessions from Kyiv while offering Russia major economic and political incentives. **A6**

◆ **U.S. sanctions** are forcing the sale of Russia's flagship oil company in Serbia. **A6**

◆ **Investigators probing** a UPS cargo jet crash that killed 14 people found signs of metal fatigue and stress in hardware that connected an engine to the plane. **A3**

◆ **A CDC webpage** that previously made the case that vaccines don't cause autism now says they might. **A4**

◆ **Fighting flared up again** in Gaza and Lebanon despite cease-fires on both fronts. **A8**

◆ **The House Ethics** Committee said it was moving forward with an investigation into Rep. Cory Mills. **A5**

◆ **Indicted Rep.** Sheila Cherfilus-McCormick relinquished her leadership post on a Foreign Affairs subcommittee. **A5**

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Delayed Jobs Report Is Strong

Fed gets little clarity on state of economy as unemployment rate hits 4-year high

By HARRIET TORRY AND JUSTIN LAHART

The U.S. labor market defied expectations in September, adding 119,000 jobs according to a report delayed nearly seven weeks by the government shutdown. At the same time, the unemployment

rate rose slightly to 4.4%, the highest level in four years.

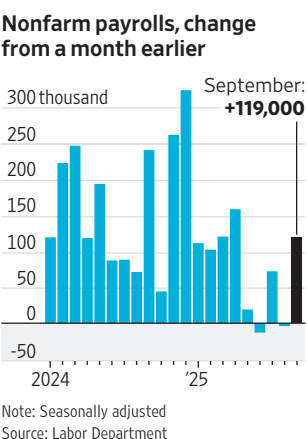
The Labor Department report leaves an already divided Federal Reserve with stale and somewhat inconclusive government data as the central bank heads into its next meeting in December.

The September numbers were eagerly anticipated and offer the first official picture of where the job market was as of two months ago. Yet they say little about how the economy is doing in this moment and where it might be headed.

This is a lingering effect of a shutdown that began on Oct. 1, only ended last week and stopped collection and reporting of some of the most important data needed to assess issues like unemployment and consumer prices.

The seasonally adjusted increase of 119,000 jobs soared above the 50,000 gain economists polled by The Wall Street Journal were expecting.

◆ **Home sales pick up, hit eight-month high..... A2**



Ex-Vice President's Life of Service Remembered



FAREWELL: Liz Cheney walked past the coffin of her father, ex-Vice President Dick Cheney, at his funeral Thursday at Washington's National Cathedral. Former presidents and vice presidents of both parties attended; President Trump wasn't invited. **A6**

Middle Class Is Buckling Under Financial Strain From Inflation

By RACHEL LOUISE ENSIGN AND RACHEL WOLFE

The U.S.'s middle class is weary.

After nearly five years of high prices, many middle-class earners thought life would be more affordable by now. Costs for goods and services are 25% above where they were in 2020, and even though the inflation rate is below its recent

2022 high, certain essentials like coffee, ground beef and car repairs are up markedly this year.

"Life felt more doable a year and a half ago," said Holly Frew, a college communications director with a household income around \$135,000 living in Atlanta. "I need to know where the light is at the end of the tunnel."

The U.S. middle class en-

compasses a broad cross section of the nation that can include white-collar office workers, nurses and plumbers, although there is no universally accepted definition.

Pew Research Center defines the middle class broadly as having a household income between about \$66,666 and \$200,000, depending on where they live. Perpetual sticker shock is making many within the

group feel worse about both their own finances and the future of the country. They are hunting for bargains and spending more carefully.

Cost-of-living issues also pushed voters this month toward candidates that promised to address what many now see as an affordability crisis. Similar issues dogged Joe Biden's re-election campaign.

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The Tiny Dogs That Can Pull 100 Times Their Weight

Competitions test strength of Chihuahuas and miniature poodles; no anabolic steroids

By CLARE ANSBERRY

PITTSBURGH—Lemon, a five-pound Chihuahua, waited at the starting line until her owner signaled "go," then pulled a wheeled cart weighing 260 pounds down a 16-foot chute.

Amid applause, the pint-size canine trotted to her crate for treats, water and rest until the next round of the North American Weight Pull Association competition. Lemon, competing in the 10-pounds-and-under weight class, pulled 52 times her weight. That would be the equivalent of a 175-pound man pulling an average-

size forklift.

"She has a lot of motivation and drive," says her owner, Erin Rios.

Chihuahuas, rat terriers and miniature poodles are muscling in on strength contests long dominated by big dogs. Major organizations, including the North American Weight Pull Association, the American Pulling Alliance and the World Wide Weight Pull Organization, have lightweight categories and awards for most weight pulled relative to size.

The rules vary, but competitions essentially involve pulling a weighted object—usually

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INSIDE

MANSION
Is \$200 million the new \$100 million in luxury real-estate sales? **M1**

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Frida Kahlo painting sells for \$54.7 million, most ever for a female artist at auction. **B1**

For Many Kids, ADHD Pills Kick Off A Drug Cascade

Children prescribed the medication often wind up on other powerful drugs

Danielle Gansky was 7 years old when an administrator at her upscale private girls' school in suburban Philadelphia flagged problems with her academic performance. She was a bubbly and creative kid, but she was easily distracted in class and her schoolwork was sloppy. The school told Gansky's mother that the girl should see a psychiatrist, who diagnosed her with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder, or ADHD, and prescribed a stimulant. Concerned that Danielle might get kicked out if her focus didn't improve, her mother broke into tears and agreed. But the pills made Gansky agitated, moody and angry. So another doctor put

By Shalini Ramachandran, Betsy McKay and Tom McGinty

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